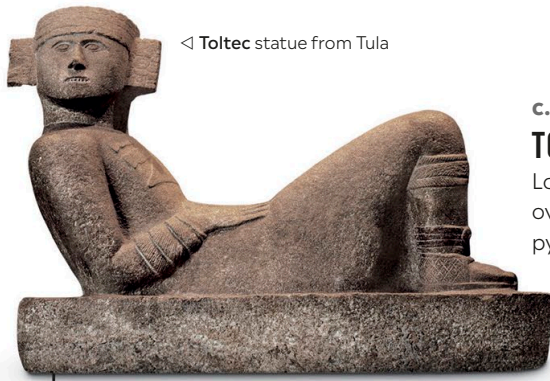




◁ Toltec statue from Tula

c. 900 CE

TOLTEC CAPITAL OF TULA FLOURISHES

Located in Hidalgo state, Mexico, Tula was the Toltec capital. Extending over some 8 sq km (3 sq miles), the city contained several temple pyramids (notably the five-stepped pyramid of Quetzalcóatl), ball courts, and many huge anthropomorphic statues of warriors. Tula was the largest city in the region between the fall of Teotihuacan and the rise of Tenochtitlan, although it is unclear whether the Toltecs built an empire or simply exercised cultural influence.

The Japanese Kokinshū anthology contains 1,111 poems

909 CE The Fatimid caliphate begins when Abdullah al-Mahdi overthrows the Aghlabids in North Africa

918 Chola King Parantaka I conquers the Pandya kingdom of southern India

919 CE

905 CE Compilation of the Kokinshū, the first anthology of Japanese poetry

907 CE

FALL OF THE TANG IN CHINA

After a long period of weak rulers, dominance of the court by eunuchs, and a series of rebellions, the last Tang emperor was deposed by Zhu Wen, a former rebel turned general, who established the short-lived Later Liang dynasty. In the following decades – the time of the Five Dynasties and Ten Kingdoms – China dissolved into a mosaic of competing states and was reunited by the Song only in 960 CE.

▷ Tang soldiers on horseback, tomb painting

